Experiment 6

Ex. No.: 6

Extraction of Browser Artifacts

Aim

To extract and review browser history and cache artefacts from an authorised Windows lab profile.

Tools required

1. ChromeHistoryView and ChromeCacheView.
2. IEHistoryView and IECacheView.
3. An authorised Windows lab profile or a forensic copy of its browser data.

Idea/Theory

1. History records can contain URL, page title, visit time, visit count, typed count, referrer, and visit identifier.
2. Cache entries may contain URL, content type, size, access and modification times, expiry, server details, and the cached file path.
3. Different browsers store artefacts in different databases and cache formats.
4. Browser artefacts may be incomplete because of private browsing, clearing, synchronisation, retention limits, or profile changes.

Experiment 6 — continued

Procedure/Steps

1. Work only on an authorised lab profile or a forensic copy; do not open a personal browser-history database.
2. Open ChromeHistoryView and select the Chrome history file or profile.
3. Review the URL, title, visit date/time, visit count, typed count, referrer, and visit ID fields.
4. Open ChromeCacheView and select the Chrome cache folder.
5. Review cached URL, content type, file size, last-accessed time, expiry, server name, and response details.
6. Preserve relevant exports and record the profile path and time-zone context.

Experiment 6 — continued

Procedure/Steps (continued)

1. Open IEHistoryView and load the authorised Internet Explorer history source.
2. Review visited URLs and their available times. The tool can save selected entries as text, HTML, or XML.
3. Open IECacheView and load the Internet Explorer cache source.
4. Review filename, content type, URL, last-accessed time, last-modified time, expiry, hit count, size, folder, and full cache path.
5. Correlate relevant history and cache records, then validate material findings against the underlying artefact.

Observation/Output

Screenshots to be attached from the lab run (tool: ChromeHistoryView, ChromeCacheView, IEHistoryView, and IECacheView)

Result

To be completed after the lab run.